

At dawn, Mira arrived at Harbor Nine with a notebook full of crossed-out plans and one clear objective: follow the drive logs. She started with the old crane logs, where entries were half technical record and half rumor. Every third line mentioned a specific bay door. By noon she had mapped the pulse windows against weather shifts and found a strange rhythm that looked less like noise and more like a signal. In the afternoon she met Teo, a retired operator who spoke in fragments. He remembered a test beacon from years ago, a single burst that had been lost in the static. At 18:40, with rain beginning and visibility dropping, Mira opened the relay panel. The first toggle silenced local alarms. When she activated channel R, the pulse resolved into packet bursts carrying old maintenance annotations, timestamps, and a few words that didn't belong. The final burst contained no numbers at all, just a sentence: if this reaches you, route traffic east for one night. Mira hesitated for only a moment before she forwarded a limited reroute to the night supervisor, flagging it as a provisional experiment. The harbor stayed still for the rest of the night.